

VIP Status

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1. Situation

This section would not be in the document if it was not a test.

It mainly contains my assumptions and some additional explanations I would usually not have to provide in a normal context (definition of ARPU 30D).

I have to make these assumptions because mobile Game Design is data driven, and I don't have access to data.

a. Assumptions

What I know:

- We want to increase ARPU 30D. To do so, we want to have an influence on one or several of the following parameters:
 - ARPPU 30D: payers should pay more or more frequently
 - 30D Conversion rate to have more payers
 - Day of first purchase to have payers start paying sooner
 - Dx: the longer a player stays and the more often (s)he comes, the more opportunities (s)he will have to convert and then to pay.

My assumptions are:

- The game currently makes more money through IAPs (OR) IAPs have currently less friction and a bigger progression margin
- The content of the game is limited and as there was a mention of *highly engaged players no longer generating revenue after day 60*, we don't want to "sell off" the content and postpone the revenue issue
 - The goal is not to milk D1-D30 players in a situation where retention would collapse after D30
- The game already has an adaptive offer system

- Adaptive offer: players have a payer profile. Depending on it, the bundles they see when session starts have different content and different prices.

As I don't have access to real offers rules, list, content, and price point, please consider the offers I created in my wireframe as illustration, not real recommendations

2. Feature introduction

a. Purpose

"VIP Status" should increase ARPU 30D by:

- Increasing conversion (low)
- Decreasing day of first purchase (medium)
- Increasing daily basket (low)
- Increasing purchase frequency (main)

"VIP Status" targets payers (low to middle spenders) and non-payers on the edge of converting (who only need a marginal additional stimulus)

b. Quick description

Payers have a "VIP Status" based on how much they spent these last 7 days

- "VIP Status" is a number, there are 3 steps: VIP1, VIP2, VIP3
- "VIP Status" is visible in the main UI
- "VIP Status" grants comfort, not a faster progression (except that it may help playing better)
 - This comfort is mainly granted through the access to new information
 - The higher the Status, the higher the amount of available information

"VIP Status" pretends to have an influence on certain offers:

- When an offer is displayed to a payer with an adapted price & content corresponding to their payer profile, "VIP [x] exclusive!" (or equivalent) is displayed
- Side note: when purchasing an offer (adaptive or not) would change player VIP Status, it is mentioned too

A "try VIP Status" feature is implemented in the first session

3. Feature description

a. VIP Status

A VIP Status is defined by:

- Its level (1, 2, 3)
- Its trigger threshold (in real currency)
 - Real currency amount is rounded up to the next unit
- Its effect
- The associated graphic assets (warning, multiple assets)

VIP Status is saved client side (and updated by server information) along with the following information:

- Highest VIP Status reached
- Ticked/unticked state for each previously unlocked status

Basics:

- Each VIP Status gives access to the display of a specific information, and access to the specific information of lower VIP statuses.
- The player can choose to display/not display each Status specific information
- Current VIP Status is displayed above the XP bar
- Tapping the XP bar area while a VIP Status is active opens the VIP pop-up displaying
 - VIP Level
 - Remaining days
 - Description of each level effect:
 - Locked/unlocked
 - If unlocked, ticked/unticked
 - If locked, lvl to unlock (icon)
 - Close button
- Tapping a ticked option unticks it
- Tapping an unticked option ticks it
- [Wireframes here](#)

Effects:

- For effects to be displayed (except effect 3), the alien must be grabbing a target
- VIP 1 displays the average food per s (total fps) won. It is the sum of each target fps with $\text{fps} = (\text{food value})/(\text{time to catch } 100\% \text{ of it currently, including group attack})$.
- VIP 2 displays the average cargo used per s (total cps). It is the sum of each target cps with $\text{cps} = (\text{cargo value})/(\text{time to catch } 100\% \text{ of it currently, including group attack})$
- VIP 3 displays the number of seconds needed for the closest Deliverer to come. Depending on tech possibilities, here are the options. Please implement the best possible option (the value doesn't need to be very accurate or too often recalculated):
 - a. Value is displayed only if alien is not moving or not moving a lot, and if deliverer is moving to the alien
 - b. Value is displayed even if deliverer is moving to home to unload
 - c. Value is displayed even if alien is moving a lot/running
- If possible, the info display is adapted to the amount of info displayed
- [Wireframes here](#)

Status evolution:

- Status is based on the [amount] of Real Currency spent in the game last [7] days. [amount thresholds] and [7] are parameters.
- Reaching an upper threshold immediately grants next status and ticks the corresponding info if this status has never been reached
- Next status is granted for at least [3] days. [3] is a parameter. Examples:

- VIP2 is 20\$ on 7 days. Victoria spends 10\$ on D1 (VIP1), then 5\$ on D3, then 5\$ on D7 (VIP2). She should lose VIP2 by the end of D8, but she will at the end of D10 (if she does no other purchase)
 - VIP3 is 100\$ on 7 days. Alex spends 15\$ everyday from D1 to D30. On D31, he doesn't spend. He loses his VIP3 status on D32.
- When a player should lose their status, they only lose one level at a time. If they do nothing, they will lose another level after [3] days. Examples:
 - If she stops spending, Victoria will be VIP1 until D13
 - If he stops spending, Alex will be VIP2 until D35, VIP1 until D38
- When a player reactivates a VIP Status (s)he previously reached, the related info state (ticked/unticked) corresponds to what it was when Status was lost.

Threshold definition: the VIP Statuses should correspond to the payer profiles defined by the game (*I don't have access to this information*)

b. VIP in offers

Reminder: I make the assumption there is an adaptive offer system in the game.

When an adaptive offer is displayed to a player (only for adaptive offers), the game pretends that the offer was unlocked by their VIP Status ([wireframes](#))

When an offer, adaptive or not, is displayed to a player with a price that would increase the player's current VIP Status, it is mentioned to the player ([wireframes](#))

c. VIP FTUE

To give a higher value to VIP Status, we want the player to experience it.

To do so, the VIP system is hacked during FTUE

Main steps are:

- Player finishes Big Heavies mission and collects reward
- A few frames after Collect Reward has disappeared, a fake offer appears
- This fake offer:
 - Has an ad offer type of wireframe
 - *Option: create a more attractive one. Warning, it must stay less attractive than real offers*
 - Rewards with 10 HC
 - Rewards with 1 day of VIP1 (hack)
 - Is free
- Once the pop-up is closed, the FTUE hand invites the player to tap on their xp level in main UI to open VIP pop-up
- VIP pop-up has a normal behavior, except that count down is based on 1 day
- When pop-up is closed, normal FTUE flow restarts, but Starter Pack is now labeled as unlocked by VIP1
- [Wireframes here](#)

Existing players:

- Non payers:

- when feature is launched, player who have already seen Starter Pack pop-up don't trigger the FTUE immediately
- If they do a purchase and activate a VIP Status, the FTUE triggers but starts at "the FTUE hand invites the player to tap on their xp level..."
- Payers
 - If they have an active VIP status when feature is launched, and have already seen Starter Pack pop-up, they trigger the FTUE immediately but it starts at "the FTUE hand invites the player to tap on their xp level..."
 - If they don't have an active VIP Status, please follow "Non payers" flow

d. Parameters and default values

Amount for each threshold (minimum)

- One parameter for each VIP Status threshold trigger
- This value is a minimum with rule : if $VIP[i]$ and $VIP[j]$ thresholds are reached and $i < j$, then $VIP[j]$ applies
- *No default value, please use some of current payer profiles thresholds*

Calculation period in days

- Number of days from [NOW] taken into account to calculate amount spent
- Default is 7 and should not change frequently

Minimal duration in days

- Minimal duration of a VIP Status when it has increased or decreased
- Default is 3

VIP exclusive in offers

- Is the label "VIP X exclusive offer !" displayed in adaptive offers? YES/NO
- A/B test related
- Default: YES

VIP unlock in offers

- Is the indication of the opportunity to activate next VIP status mentioned in offers? YES/NO
- A/B test related
- Default: YES

Full feature is visible/invisible

- Ability to deactivate the display of full feature, ON/OFF
- The feature still "exists", meaning that the game still knows what is the VIP Status of each player, for how long, etc. But it's invisible to the player
- A/B test related
- Feature launch related
- Default is NO if feature is delivered by pieces. Becomes YES when feature is fully launched.

Reward for FTUE treasure:

- Defines the content of Fake Offer reward during FTUE
- It should be possible on parameters side to define 2 or 3 rewards instead of 1
- Default: 10 HC

Hacked duration for FTUE treasure

- Defines how many days/hours of VIP1 are given by Fake Offer
- Warning: either by choosing "hours" or by using a float in the parameter, it should be possible to set a duration inferior to 1 day.

4. Feature evaluation

a. Required analytic events

2 new parameters, “Current VIP Status” (CVS) and “Next VIP Status” (NVS), are added in some existing events

Some new events are also required, and will use CVS and/or NVS parameter

- If an event tracks “offer displayed”, triggering each time an offer is displayed with offer ID and content, CVS parameters is added
- CVS is added to Real Currency purchase events (VIP status before purchase is made)
 - NVS is added too if this purchase has changed the player VIP Status
- CVS is added to Hard Currency purchase events (when buying “something else” with HC)
- A new event is created, tracking the manual changes in displayed/non displayed information in VIP pop-up
 - Parameters:
 - Usual parameters (timestamp, user ID, ...)
 - CVS
 - ID of info changed (1,2 or 3)
 - Change (to on or to off)
 - Additional requirements
 - The event is only sent when the pop-up is closed. We assume that the loss of information due to crashing or closing the app at this precise moment is minor.
 - Of course, only the final state is taken into account (“untick info1 then re-tick, then close the pop-up” doesn’t send an event)
 - If changes were made for several info ID, *if possible* only one event is sent with all the IDs and changes
- Optional: A new event is created, to track that the VIP pop-up was open at least once in the session
 - Parameters:
 - Usual parameters (timestamp, user ID, ...)
 - Concerned UI: VIP Status pop-up
 - If it doesn’t exist yet, this event can be reused for other UI we would like to track

b. Required A/B test

We would like to set 2 A/B test

A/B test “feature activated” VS “feature not activated”

- “Feature not activated” group should be small, as we will only use it to check that the control sample has an ARPU30 similar to the one we had before the launch of the feature.
- The control group will also allow us to follow gap in ARPU without waiting for D30

A/B test “Display VIP in offers (VIP exclusive! & next status)” / “Don’t”

- Each group should have a decent size, as the difference in results may be small
- There are only 2 groups, “Display Vip Exclusive” & “Display next status” on one side, and “Don’t display Vip Exclusive” & “Don’t display next status” status on the other side
- Indeed, having an A/B/C/D/E test including “Display Vip Exclusive” & “Don’t display next status” as C and “Don’t display Vip Exclusive” & “Display next status” as D would dilute too much the information, especially considering that there is most probably an additional group (even if small), “feature not activated”

c. Expected results

i. Convert sooner (medium)

Some players who already almost decided to pay in the app but postponed it to “when they will really need it” (for example, to choose the size of the pack) will pay sooner to keep their VIP1 status, or get it back.

ii. Convert more (low)

Some players who would not have paid but were hesitating will convert because of this extra value (for the same price)

iii. Increase daily basket to try (and keep) next VIP Status (low-medium)

Some players who would have purchased lower price-point offers (price-point A) will try a purchase with a higher price-point (price-point B) to experience the next VIP level.

Our assumption is that these players will compare the full content of each offer, take into consideration the higher discount of the more expensive one, will have planning reasoning (“I know I will spend 10\$ three times in a month, maybe spending 30\$ now for more content is the right move”).

Still, it’s the VIP Status which provided the small additional stimuli needed to trigger this switch of behavior.

We know that the most difficult part is to “do it for the first time”, much more than “re-do it”; so part of these players will keep buying the price-point B offers/packs

iv. Increase purchase frequency to keep VIP Status (main)

Players used to having a VIP Status will include it in their behavior and buy more frequently (instead of postponing) to keep it.

This is the main goal of the feature.

The combination of these factors should significantly increase ARPU Day 30